

LOVESKIN

The Complete Skin Routine Guide

A short, practical companion to building (and sticking to) an AM/PM skincare routine that actually fits your skin type.

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How to use this guide

This guide walks through the same core logic behind your LoveSkin quiz results: identify your skin type and main concern, then build routines in the correct product order. Use it as a reference whenever your skin, the season, or your goals change.

Step 1 — Know your skin type

- **Oily** — shine by midday, visible pores, more prone to breakouts.
- **Dry** — tight or flaky feeling, especially after cleansing.
- **Combination** — oily T-zone, normal-to-dry cheeks.
- **Normal** — balanced, few recurring issues.
- **Sensitive** — reacts easily to new products, redness or stinging.

Your skin type can shift with weather, stress, and hormones — it's worth re-checking every few months rather than treating it as fixed.

Step 2 — Pick your main focus

- **Acne** — breakouts, clogged pores, texture.
- **Dullness** — uneven tone, tired-looking skin.
- **Aging** — fine lines, loss of firmness.
- **Dark spots** — post-acne marks, sun spots.
- **Redness** — visible flushing or irritation.

Pick one primary concern to build around. Layering too many active ingredients for multiple concerns at once is the most common cause of irritation.

Step 3 — Morning (AM) routine order

1. Cleanser — a gentle, low-foam formula to avoid stripping overnight repair.
2. Treatment — a light antioxidant serum (e.g. vitamin C) if your skin tolerates it.
3. Moisturizer — matched to your skin type (gel for oily, richer cream for dry).
4. SPF — broad-spectrum, SPF 30+, every single day regardless of weather.

SPF is the single highest-impact step in any routine — for aging, dark spots, and redness in particular, consistent daily SPF outperforms almost any other product.

Step 4 — Evening (PM) routine order

- 1. Cleanser (double-cleanse if wearing sunscreen or makeup).
- 2. Treatment — this is where active ingredients go (retinoids, exfoliating acids, spot treatments).
- 3. Moisturizer — slightly richer than your AM formula to support overnight repair.

Introduce one new active at a time, 2–3 nights a week to start. Give any new product two to four weeks before judging results — most actives take that long to show a visible difference.

Building routine complexity

- **Minimal (3 steps)** — cleanse, treat, moisturize (+ SPF in the AM). Good for beginners or sensitive skin.
- **Standard (5 steps)** — adds a toner or essence and an eye cream.
- **Comprehensive (7–8 steps)** — layers serums, masks, and targeted treatments for specific concerns.

More steps isn't automatically better — it's more room for something to irritate your skin. Add one product at a time and give your skin a chance to tell you how it feels.

General tips

- Patch test any new product on your inner forearm for 24 hours before applying to your face.
- Introduce actives gradually — never start retinoids and acids in the same week.
- Reapply SPF if you're outdoors for extended periods.
- Retake the LoveSkin quiz whenever your skin, season, or goals change — routines aren't meant to be permanent.

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